Lesson plan · for the teacher

Pupils' data needs care

Data engineering · Level 1 · Lesson 4

Time
40 min

Materials
About ten data cards per group (paper, one kind of data on each); One form your school uses: enrolment, trip or club

Learning goals

- Recognise personal and sensitive data.
- Practise the four habits that keep it safe.
- Decide what's fine to share, what needs care and what stays private.

Activity: Fine, care or private

1. Warm-up (5 min): Ask pupils to list things the school knows about them: name, class, birthday, marks, address, a parent's phone. Write the kinds of data on the board, never a pupil's own details.
2. Teach (8 min): Explain personal data and sensitive data with examples, and why children's data needs the most care. Show how small facts add up: a school, a birthday, a route home.
3. Sort (15 min): Groups sort the data cards into fine to share, share with care and keep private, and write who may see each card.
4. Compare (7 min): Each group shows one card it found hard. The class agrees on a pile, and the reason for it.
5. Wrap-up (5 min): Ask each pupil for one habit they'll keep, such as asking before sharing a photo. Then give the exit ticket.

Use only made-up or general cards, never a real pupil's details. Be ready for sensitive questions about home or health: answer generally, and follow up privately if needed.

Discussion

- Which card was hardest to sort, and why?
- How can small facts about you add up to find you?
- What should a teacher do before posting a class photo?

Exit ticket

- Name one fact that's fine to share, one that needs care and one that stays private.

Try it in class tomorrow
Play "Fine, care or private" with your pupils: groups sort data cards (favourite food, class, home address, phone number, a photo, a test mark) into three piles, and say who may see each one.

Worksheet · for pupils

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Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

1 **A trip form asks for each pupil's religion, home address, phone and blood group. What should you do?**

- ◯ Ask only what the trip needs: an emergency contact and health needs
- ◯ Collect it all, just in case
- ◯ Post the form in the class WhatsApp group

2 **Which of these are sensitive data about a pupil? Choose all that apply.**

- ☐ A disability
- ☐ Their family's religion
- ☐ Their favourite subject
- ☐ The class they're in
- ☐ A health condition

3 **If a fact about a pupil is harmless on its own, it's always safe to share.**

- ◯ True
- ◯ False

4 **Match each habit to an example of it at school.**

Collect only what you need	• • • •	The marks sheet is shared with the head, not the whole staff room
Only the right people see it	• • • •	Trip forms are shredded after the trip
Keep it locked	• • • •	The trip form asks for an emergency contact, not religion
Delete it when no longer needed	• • • •	A PIN on the phone that holds the class photos

Answers · for the teacher

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1 **Ask only what the trip needs: an emergency contact and health needs**

Collect only what the purpose needs. A trip needs a way to reach a parent in an emergency and to know about allergies or health needs, kept with care and deleted after the trip.

2 **A health condition; Their family's religion; A disability**

Health, religion and disability can bring special harm if they're shared, so they need the most care.

3 **False**

Harmless facts add up: a school, a birthday and a route home together can lead a stranger to a child.

4 **Collect only what you need — The trip form asks for an emergency contact, not religion**
Only the right people see it — The marks sheet is shared with the head, not the whole staff room
Keep it locked — A PIN on the phone that holds the class photos
Delete it when no longer needed — Trip forms are shredded after the trip

Each habit closes a different door: less is collected, fewer people see it, it's locked when no one is looking, and it doesn't hang around after its job is done.

For you to think about

Where does your class's data live: on paper, on your phone, in a WhatsApp group? Which one habit would protect it most?